

Why Feedback is Important Video Transcript

I was 11 years old, playing a tennis match. Now, I was losing this tennis match, pretty hardly actually. And beside the court stood my trainer.

And for every point I lost, he offered me advice, he offered me feedback. Now, did you listen as a child? No, I didn't. No, no.

I was entitled, I was stubborn, and I did not listen. I did not only lose the match that day, I lost my trainer's confidence, and shortly after, I even lost my trainer. I was never able to regain my trainer's confidence.

But I had not listened to his feedback, and this was the consequence. Now, ladies and gentlemen, my name is Sam Elsey, and I'm here today to talk to you, parents, teachers, and teenagers. Because the simple fact is, I was a brat, maybe even a jerk.

And what changed me, what made me become what I am today? It's a simple word, feedback. But before I go into feedback, let me first tell you who I am. So my name is Sam Elsey.

I'm a 17-year-old student from Licea and Meurich, just beside here. Actually, it's right to the left. And I love to engage myself.

I'm the president of its student council. I'm the vice president of the Luxembourg Youth Parliament. And I consider myself to be quite a responsible guy.

But this wasn't always the case. It's even rather a recent phenomenon. So what changed me is feedback.

Feedback. Confused, please stay with me here. First, let's answer the question.

Who here knows what feedback is? Or who here believes he knows what feedback is? Just put your arms in the air, come on. Damn, that's a sizable amount. Christ.

So, ladies and gentlemen, what is feedback? Well, feedback is quite simple. My action. Your reaction.

Well, or none. And my observation and adaption to that reaction. Seeing your reaction and then adapting to my new circumstances.

Now, feedback is omnipresent. I see you guys. That's visual feedback.

I might hear some of you whisper. Auditive feedback. I feel stuff.

Sensory feedback. But today, I will talk about the most important feedback there is for human interaction. Social feedback.

The feedback one human provides to another. Now, ladies and gentlemen, I barely ever listened to feedback. You can ask my parents right there.

I was stubborn. But what changed me? What made me become this new me? Made me evolve? Well, a year ago, I joined this new public speaking lesson in my school. And arrogant as I was, I thought I had mastered public speaking.

That I would not need to listen to some teacher or anyone. This new teacher made me present in front of class. And so I did.

I thought I had done a perfect job. Now, my classmates did as well. And at that point, I thought, why are we even in this class? I mean, you've got the best of Lise and Mayrisch.

That must mean something. And this new teacher, after having listened to us, he patiently came in front of the class. And he absolutely demolished us.

I mean, humiliated. Now, I was almost crying. Some of my classmates actually were.

I will not mention any names. Some of them are amongst the audience. But it truly was horrifying.

But I loved it. My classmates did as well. Now, why did I love it? Now, I'm not a masochist.

Nor do I believe my classmates to be. But why did we love this feedback? I actually thought about it. What made it so special? So different from anything that I had ever received before? It's four words.

And please, please keep them in mind. This feedback was contextual. It was constructive.

It was concise. And it was concrete. And it would make you realize your own mistake.

You'd be standing there in front of your class, being humiliated. And he'd tell you, you have to improve your intonation. And you'd literally realize your mistake.

You'd realize what you could do better. You'd improve on the spot. That is the power of feedback.

The power to change people. Now, ladies and gentlemen, it's through this insightful lesson that I learned I am not my potential. Neither are you yours.

Please, look to the person to your left. Come on. Don't be shy.

They look beautiful, don't they? Now, look to the person to your right. Oh, what splendor. That is your potential.

The people around you, your network, your family, your friends, that is your potential. The wisdom, intelligence, the lessons and knowledge they have to offer can shape you in unimaginable and amazing ways. Now, ladies and gentlemen, you now have learned how important feedback is, how it can truly change your life, how you can evolve to become a new person.

But there is nothing better than giving feedback. I mean, just the act of it, seeing someone improve, seeing someone become better, become stronger, it's beautiful. But feedback is like a gift.

So, let me ask you, how do you give a gift? Do you throw it in someone's face? I don't. Feedback is a gift, so treat it as such. What do you do with a gift? You make it look nice.

You put some gift wrap around it, maybe even a ribbon. You give it at the right time, in the right manner, accompanied by the right words. But ladies and gentlemen, giving feedback is hard, is it not? Who here struggles giving feedback? Come on, just show me your arms.

That's sad. That's sad in a society based upon communication. Now, ladies and gentlemen, today I will give you four tricks, four words, starting with C, which will make it far easier for you to give feedback.

And we all want to give feedback. I mean, placing that seed in someone's mind, which will slowly grow into this better, stronger person, this new plant, this new person. So, ladies and gentlemen, oops, I did not want to show that, but who knows the four Cs? Come on, just shout them out.

Wait, contextual, next. Oh, I love that. So, next, come on.

Guys, wow. Either you have really good eyes or you really listen well. I hope it's both.

So, good feedback follows these four criteria, the four magical Cs. So, why does it do that? I'll go through it with you. I'll be generous today.

So, good feedback is contextual. Now, imagine you're crying. Imagine you're having a mental breakdown and someone walks up to you, could have done that better.

Would you listen to him? No, no one would. So, instead, choose the right time. Choose a moment when the person is the most receptive to give them the feedback.

Then, secondly, be constructive. Who agrees there's far too much negativity in this world? There you go. So, don't just tell them this is bad.

No one wants to hear that. No one does. Instead, give them a compliment.

Cecilia, your speech was so inspiring. And then, I would offer them what they could do better, but with Cecilia, there's nothing she could have done better. It was amazing.

But, if you follow these, well, furthermore, then concise. No one likes a lofty explanation. Who here has had their mother shout at them for five to ten minutes? Who stops listening after one minute? Thirty seconds? Ten seconds? For me, it's two seconds.

Love you, Mom. So, instead, keep it short. Five to ten phrases, max.

Good feedback is short. It's sexy. And then, be concrete.

No feedback is finished. No feedback is fulfilled or complete without a concrete example of what you can improve. Now, ladies and gentlemen, if you will follow these four, then it will be easy for you to plant a seed, which will grow into a new plant, a new person.

And we all want to do that. Who here wants to help the people you love, you care about? Come on, guys. But, ladies and gentlemen, sadly, we do not live in a perfect world.

Whilst we all want to give on our seeds, not all of our seeds are good. That sounds strange. But, point being, not everyone who should be giving feedback... Oh, sorry.

It's the other way around, actually. Not everyone should be giving feedback, sadly. And distinguishing what is good feedback from bad feedback is the only way to become successful, if that be as a teenager, if that be in your work life.

Now, how do you distinguish good and bad feedback? There again, I'm generous today. I'll actually give you the criteria. It's three criteria.

So, source. Who is giving you the feedback? Then, furthermore, motive. With which intention are they giving you the feedback? And then, lastly, kredos.

The Greek word for credibility, or so I believe. With which qualifications is this person giving you feedback? If these check out, please use the feedback. As I've told you, it will change your life, make you become something you could have never thought you could become.

But, if they don't check out, consider disregarding it. Now, ladies and gentlemen, during this presentation, I hope that I have taught you how important feedback is. That whilst using it, you can help yourself become a better person, and can help that teenager in your home, in your class, or your friends to become a better person, to plant that seed.

Whilst, at the same time, teaching you that when receiving feedback, you need to know which feedback is good and which is bad. Ladies and gentlemen, thank you very much.